

30. Which one of the following is not commercial crop?

- (a) Sugarcane (b) Cotton
(c) Banana (d) Bajra

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

Among the given crops, millet is not a commercial crop, whereas sugarcane, cotton and banana come under the category of commercial crops and are also called cash crops. However, it should be remembered that the level of commercialization of agriculture is different in different state. For example, in Haryana and Punjab, rice is a commercial crop but in Odisha it is a subsistence crop.

Food Crops

i. Rabi Crops

*In India, due to ecological differences in various regions different types of crop cycles are adopted. For example, rice and wheat in Punjab, Haryana, West U.P. etc. There are three different crop seasons in India –

Rabi Crops

Kharif Crops

Zaid Crops

*Rabi Crops are sown in winter between October and November and harvested in summer between March and April. Major Rabi crops are - **Wheat, Mustard, Potato, Gram, Pea, Lentil, Barley** etc. In winter, rainfalls due to temperate western disturbances help in the production of these crops.

*Wheat is the second most important food crops of India. It is produced in north and north-western regions. For the cultivation of wheat, the temperature should be between **10°C-25°C** and an average annual rainfall of **50 to 75 cm evenly distributed over the growing season** is required.

*According to Economic Survey data 2024-25, the cultivation of wheat in India is done on 31.8 Million Hectare (2023-24). Some important species of wheat are - **Sonalika, Arjun, Kundan, Amar (HW-2004), Bhawani (HW-1085), Chandrika (HPW-184), Deshratna (BR-104), Kanchan (DL-803), Gomti (K-9465)** etc. For the enhancement in production of wheat in India, **dwarf species** has been developed for wheat by agricultural scientists. In which Lerma Rojo 64-A, Sonora-63, Sonora-64, Mayo 64 and S-227 have been examined in wheat productive states of the Country.

*Due to the successful tests of dwarf species, the production of wheat has been increased. **Norin-10** is a gene of dwarfism in Wheat. **Macaroni wheat** is suitable for cultivation in dry condition or unirrigated area. Kalyan Sona (Kalyan Gold) is an advanced type of wheat species.

***Yellow rust, Brown rust and Black rust** are three types of rust diseases found in wheat.

***Karnal Bunt** is a fungal disease of wheat. This disease occurs from **Tilletia Indica Fungi**. The disease was first recognized in the year 1931.

***Tirtikale** is a hybrid of wheat and rye.

*According to 2023-24 data, **Uttar Pradesh** (35.34 million tonnes) is the largest producer of wheat. Madhya Pradesh (22.58 million tonnes) and Punjab (17.74 million tonnes) are placed at second and third position respectively.

1. In which months is the Rabi crop sown?

- (a) March-April (b) June-July
(c) October-November (d) January-February

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

On the basis of seasons, the crops in India have been divided into three types.

Kharif crops: The Kharif crop is the summer crop or monsoon crop in India. Kharif crops are usually sown with the beginning of the first rains i.e in June- July and harvested in October - November.

Major Kharif crops of India include Millets (Bajra & Jowar), Cotton, Soyabean, Sugarcane, Turmeric, Paddy (Rice), Maize, Moong (Pulses), Groundnut, Red Chillies, etc.

Rabi Crops: The Rabi crop is the spring harvest or winter crop in India. It is sown in October-November last and harvested in March-April every year. Major Rabi crops in India include Wheat, Barley, Mustard, Sesame, Peas, Potatoes.

Zaid Crop: This crop is grown in some parts of the country from March to July. Prominent examples are Muskmelon, Watermelon, Vegetables of Cucurbitaceae family such as bitter gourd, pumpkin, ridged gourd, etc.

2. Which of the following is a "Rabi" crop :

- (a) Cotton (b) Maize
(c) Tur (d) Mustard

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. Rabi crops are sown :

- (a) From October to November
(b) From December to March

- (c) From May to July
(d) From August to September

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Which of the following is not a Kharif Crop ?

- (a) Groundnut (b) Maize
(c) Masoor (d) Paddy

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Which of the following is not a Rabi Crop ?

- (a) Lady's finger (b) Carrot
(c) Radish (d) Pea

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. Which is not a Kharif Crop –

- (a) Paddy (b) Gram
(c) Maize (d) Jwar

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. Which of the following is odd on the basis of crops?

- (a) Paddy (b) Jowar
(c) Maize (d) Wheat

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

In the above options, wheat is Rabi crop and rest all are Kharif crops.

8. Which one of the following sets of conditions is necessary for good cultivation of wheat?

- (a) Moderate temperature and moderate rainfall
(b) High temperature and heavy rainfall
(c) High temperature and moderate rainfall
(d) Low temperature and low rainfall

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

In India, wheat requires 10° to 25° C temperature and 50 to 75 cm evenly distributed average annual rainfall which can be termed as moderate temperature and moderate rainfall. Wheat is grown on 31.8 million hectare area (2023-24) of the total cropped area.

9. Cash Crop does not consist –

- (a) Sugarcane (b) Cotton
(c) Jute (d) Wheat

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

Cash crops include Sugarcane, Cotton, Jute, Tobacco, Oilseeds etc and Wheat, Rice etc. are food crops.

10. Which group of crops mentioned below comprises of Cash Crop ?

- (a) Wheat, Maize, Rice
(b) Gram, Peas, Wheat
(c) Cotton, Sugarcane, Bananas
(d) Rice, Gram, Tea

M.P.P.C.S (Pre) 1998

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. With which of the following countries has India done an agreement to import 15 lakh tonnes wheat with a view to the possibility of less production?

- (a) Australia (b) Mexico
(c) U.S.A. (d) Canada

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (a)

Government of India in the year 1998 signed an agreement with Australia to import 15 lakhs tonnes of Wheat.

12. What was the total production of wheat in India as per the 4th advance estimates in the year 2020-21?

- (a) 209.5 million tonnes (b) 501.5 million tonnes
(c) 201.23 million tonnes (d) 109.5 million tonnes
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above.

67th B.P.S.C. Re Exam (Pre) 2022

Ans. (d)

When the question was asked option (d) was correct answer. According to Economic Survey data 2024-25, the total production of wheat in India in 2023-24 was 113.3 million tonnes.

13. Which one of the following sequence is correct in the context of the three largest wheat producing states?

- (a) Punjab, Uttar Pradesh and Haryana
(b) Uttar Pradesh, Haryana and Punjab
(c) Uttar Pradesh, Punjab and Haryana
(d) Punjab, Haryana and Uttar Pradesh

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (c)

Three largest wheat producing states, when this question was asked, were – Uttar Pradesh, Punjab and Haryana. According to 2024-25 Economic Survey data, in 2023-24 three largest producers of wheat are –
(i) Uttar Pradesh (ii) Madhya Pradesh (iii) Punjab.

14. The highest wheat-producing state of India is-

- (a) Haryana (b) Punjab
(c) Bihar (d) Uttar Pradesh

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

15. Which among the following States was the largest producer of wheat in India in the year 2015-16?

- (a) Haryana (b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Punjab (d) Bihar

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

According to Agriculture Statistics at a glance (in 2015-16) issued by Agriculture and Farmers Welfare department, the three largest producers of wheat are as follows :

State	Production 2015-16 (M. tonnes)	2023-24 (M. tonnes)
Uttar Pradesh	25.43	35.34
Punjab	16.08	17.74
Madhya Pradesh	17.69	22.58

16. The State that yields 'maximum production of wheat' in India is –

- (a) Haryana (b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Punjab (d) Bihar

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

Uttar Pradesh yields maximum production of wheat in India. At present, (2023-24) percent share of wheat production throughout India is highest in U.P. (35.34 million tonnes) followed by Madhya Pradesh (22.58 million tonnes) and Punjab (17.74 Million tonnes).

17. 'Mahi Sugandha' is a variety of

- (a) Rice (b) Wheat
(c) Sunflower (d) Mustard

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (a)

Mahi Sugandha is a variety of Basmati Rice. It has longer grains and is non-sticky elongated after cooking. Other varieties of rice are - Abha (R-155-355), Ajay (CRHR-7), Akashi, Ambika, Deepti, Divya Gajapati (IET-13251), Garima Geetanjali (CRM-2007-1).

18. Uttar Pradesh ranks first in the production of which of the following crops?

- (a) Rice and Wheat (b) Wheat and Sugarcane
(c) Rice and Sugarcane (d) Wheat and Pulses

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

According to Economic Survey 2024-25 for the Year 2023-24, Uttar Pradesh ranks first in the production of Wheat and Sugarcane.

19. Which of the following wheat varieties has been developed through induced mutation?

- (a) Kalyan Sona (b) Sonora-64
(c) Sharbati Sonara (d) Sonalika

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (b)

To increase the possibility of increasing the wheat production in India, scientists introduced five dwarf wheat varieties, viz, Lerma Rojo 64-A, Sonora-63, Sonora 64, Mayo 64 and S227. Sonora-64 was developed through an induced mutation exercise at IARI, which increases the production of wheat.

20. Dwarfing gene in Wheat is –

- (b) Norin - 10 (b) Dee-gee-woo-gen
(c) Opaque - 2 (d) None of the above

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

Norin 10 is dwarfing gene of wheat, Dee-Gee-Woo-gen is for rice and 'Opaque-2' gene is related to maize.

21. Macaroni wheat is most suitable under what conditions–

- (a) Highly irrigated conditions
(b) Late sown conditions
(c) Rainfed conditions
(d) None of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (c)

The production of Macaroni wheat is most suitable under rainfed conditions.

22. Raj 3077 is a variety of –

- (a) Maize (b) Jowar
(c) Rice (d) Wheat

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (d)

Raj 3077 is a variety of wheat. It is sown late. Its average production is 36-40 quintals per hectare. Other varieties of wheat include – Sonalika, Arjun, Kundan, Amar (HW-2004), Bhawani (HW-1085), Chandrika (HPW- 184), Deshratna (BR-104), Kanchan (DR-803), Girija Gomti (K-9465), Prabhani (51-PUSA) etc.

23. 'Pusa Sindhu Ganga' is a variety of

- (a) Wheat (b) Paddy
(c) Lentil (d) Gram

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (a)

Pusa Sindhu Ganga (HD 2967) is a variety of wheat identified by 48th All India Wheat and Barley Research Workers Meet held at IARI, New Delhi.

24. UP-308 is a variety of

- (a) Rice (b) Wheat
(c) Cotton (d) Millet

U.P. Lower Sub. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

U.P. 308 is Mexican dwarf wheat variety. It is mainly used in Darbhanga district of Bihar.

25. The production of wheat in India during 2006-07 and 2009-10 has –

- (a) Maintained an upward trend
(b) Experienced a shortfall
(c) Experienced fluctuations
(d) Remained stagnant

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (a)

The production of wheat in India increased during 2006-07 and 2009-10. In the year 2006-07 the production of wheat was 75.81 million tonnes, in 2007-08 it was 78.57 million tonnes, in 2008-09 it was 80.68 million tonnes and in 2009-10 it was 80.80 million tonnes. In the year 2023-24, it reached to 113.3 million tonnes.

26. Which of the following is not a hybrid variety of wheat developed by the Indira Gandhi Krishi Vishwavidyalaya, Raipur?

- (a) Kanishka (b) Ratan
(c) Indira Sona (d) Arpa

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

Indira Gandhi Agricultural University, Raipur, has developed the advanced hybrid variety of Indira sona rice. The major improved wheat varieties developed by it include Ratan, Kanishka, Ambar, Vidya, Mavanti etc.

27. Which one of the following is a disease of the wheat crop :

- (a) Blast (b) Tikka
(c) Dust (d) Rust

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2003

Ans. (d)

Wheat is affected by three different types of Rust diseases: Yellow Rust, Brown Rust and Black Rust.

28. Kalyana Sona is a variety of-

- (a) Rice (b) Maize
(c) Wheat (d) Jowar

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (c)

Kalyana Sona is a high yielding variety of wheat.

29. Consider the following high yielding varieties of crops in India:

1. Arjun 2. Jaya
3. Padma 4. Sonalika

Which of these is wheat?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 4 (d) 3 and 4

I.A.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

Sonalika and Arjun are varieties of wheat while Jaya and Padma are varieties of rice.

30. Variety of pigeon pea(Arhar) suitable for double cropping with wheat is-

- (a) N. A-1
(b) Bahar
(c) U.P.A.S-120
(d) None of the Above

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Mains) 2010

Ans. (c)

U.P.A.S-120 is a suitable variety of pigeon pea(Arhar) that can be used for double cropping with wheat. Other varieties of Arhar are I.C.P.L.-151, I.C.P.L.-87, Bahar, N.D.A.-I etc.

31. Consider the following statements :

- Highest production of wheat in India is obtained from the state of U.P.
- Cropping pattern occupying the highest area in U.P. is rice-wheat.